



A NEW SOUTH TECHNOLOGIES PROPRIETARY METHODOLOGY

The Governed Agile Framework (GAF)

Speed Without Sacrifice:

Delivering Federal Innovation with Zero Risk

How to integrate NIST compliance, FedRAMP authorization, and Agile delivery in a single, seamless workflow.

Prepared by: **New South Technologies** | June 2026

01 THE PROBLEM

The "Agile vs. Governance" Trap

In federal IT, teams are often forced to choose between speed (Agile) and safety (Compliance). The result is a damaging false choice — one that costs agencies time, money, and mission effectiveness.

⚠ The Old Way

Developers sprint for months, then hit a "compliance wall" — freezing all work to manually document everything and wait weeks for an auditor.

Result: Burnout, missed deadlines, and failed authorizations.

✓ The Reality

Compliance should not be a phase at the end of a project. It must be embedded in the DNA of every sprint — from backlog grooming to deployment.

Result: Continuous delivery with zero audit surprises.

The Solution

The Governed Agile Framework (GAF) — a proprietary methodology developed by New South Technologies that transforms compliance from a bottleneck into a **competitive advantage**.

02 CORE PRINCIPLES

Three Pillars of GAF

Every engagement built on the Governed Agile Framework rests on three mutually reinforcing pillars. Together they eliminate the compliance wall and make audit readiness a byproduct of good engineering.

01 Compliance-as-Code	02 Continuous Authorization	03 Embedded Governance
Approach Policies are encoded directly into infrastructure — not written in Word docs after the fact. Example A Terraform script enforcing encryption automatically satisfies NIST SC-28. No manual checklists. Benefit: If the build passes, the control is satisfied. Evidence is generated automatically.	Approach Every user story includes a Control Check. The SSP updates in real-time via eMASS or ServiceNow API. Benefit Replaces the 'Big Bang' ATO every 3 years with incremental authorization. Benefit: The system is always audit-ready. An OIG walk-in finds no surprises.	Approach Security is not a separate team — the ISSO sits in the Daily Scrum. Compliance Debt is prioritized alongside features. Roles ISSO in sprint ceremonies; Product Owner owns compliance backlog items. Benefit: Risks are identified in hours, not months.

03 THE WORKFLOW

From Backlog to Authorization

The GAF workflow transforms every sprint phase. Where traditional programs treat governance as a final gate, GAF embeds it at each step — turning compliance evidence into an automatic byproduct of delivery.

SPRINT PHASE	TRADITIONAL APPROACH	GOVERNED AGILE (GAF)
Planning	Define features only.	Define features + map to NIST controls.
Development	Code in isolation.	Code with automated security scans (SAST/DAST).
Testing	Manual QA + Manual Security Test.	Automated Policy Verification + Pen-test integration.
Review	Demo feature functionality.	Demo feature + generate evidence artifact.
Deploy	Freeze for 4 weeks for audit.	Deploy immediately if automated gates pass.
Audit	Panic collection of screenshots.	Review pre-generated, immutable logs.

The "Definition of Done" in GAF

A story is not "Done" until all four gates are satisfied:

- ✓ Code is merged into the main branch.
- ✓ Vulnerability scan is clean (zero critical findings).
- ✓ Control mapping is updated in the System Security Plan (SSP).
- ✓ Immutable audit log entry is created and timestamped.

04 OUTCOMES & IMPACT

Why Agencies Choose GAF

GAF delivers measurable results across the delivery lifecycle — faster velocity, stronger compliance posture, and teams that are energized rather than exhausted.

40%

Faster Time-to-Value

Eliminate compliance freeze periods and ship continuously.

100%

Audit Readiness

Pass OIG inspections on demand, any time, with zero preparation.

Zero

Compliance Debt Surprise

Security gaps are fixed during sprints, not discovered in audits.



Higher Team Morale

Developers ship value; ISSOs have clean, trustworthy data.

Real-World Impact

“Not just a cloud migration — a cultural rewiring.”

“New South Technologies didn’t just move our legacy system to the cloud; they rewired our entire culture. We now ship weekly updates without ever worrying about an audit finding.”

— Federal CIO, Major Civilian Agency

05 NEXT STEPS

Ready to Reclaim Your Velocity?

Don't let compliance slow down your mission. Adopt the framework that aligns speed with safety — and makes governance a competitive advantage, not a bottleneck.

Get a Free GAF Assessment

Discover how your current processes measure up against the Governed Agile standard. Our team will review your existing sprint workflow, compliance posture, and authorization status — then deliver a tailored roadmap at no cost.

Get in Touch

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What Happens Next

- ✓ Schedule a 30-min discovery call
- ✓ Receive a custom GAF gap analysis
- ✓ Get a no-cost roadmap within 5 business days

“We build the governance that makes agility possible.”

— New South Technologies

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